

PROCESS

The assignment was as follows: "Design a memorial pavilion / experience for an endangered species (flora/fauna) or a disappearing natural phenomenon."

I choose the act of picking (black)berries out in the wild, something that even some of my friends in my age group had never done. That combined with the increasing ignorance of where our food comes from, made this an interesting topic to explore.

I started with some models to explore the shape and the experience of the pavilion. I initially wasn't sure if I could use the "real" berries, so an idea where you would pick berry shaped beads, and create a berry memory bracelet was explored.

The real picking experience become too important, so a pavilion that could be a place of education and processing of the berries made the most sense. The structure itself providing shelter, and the perfect growing space for the black berries. After some research I found that the picking of berries is considered poaching in Dutch forests, so I had to not only think of a memorial, but also a semi-regulated space where the berries could be picked.

My initial physical models got translated into 3D renderings in Blender, where I explored the shape language and scale even further. The shapes had to include a lot of surface area and nooks & crannies for the black berry vine to hold on too and provide a varying amount of sunshine and shadow. The scale had to be small enough to be easily maintained by forest staff, given the blackberries tendency to spread rapidly.